B2 LESSON 2

4 QUALITY EDUCATION

Education for All

Introduction

Ss find out more about SDGs/Global Goals and about SDG 4 'Quality education'. They read a list of obstacles to accessing quality education in the world and reflect on the connections between education and poverty. Ss are encouraged to make proposals for possible ways to tackle the problem locally, within their communities. This is a good way for them to reflect on the responsibility given to all of us, not only to institutions and governments, by the SDGs.

STEP 1 RAISING AWARENESS

1 A **Point to the two photos and ask Ss to describe them. Ask: *What/Who can you see? What is happening in each photo? What looks the same/different in the photos?* The purpose of this initial activity is to make Ss reflect on the fact that going to school is not something which should be taken for granted. There are places in the world where the right to education is limited. Then ask Ss to reflect on their own experience and ask them to complete the sentences. Compare ideas around the class.**

B **Put Ss into pairs and allow time for them to read and discuss the questions. Monitor and help with vocabulary if asked to. Briefly check answers as a class. Through these two questions, Ss will consider the importance of being able to access education. If possible, the following factors should be highlighted during the class discussion.**

Education:

- gives us tools to understand the world around us.
- helps to develop personal skills.
- provides the opportunity for access to better jobs.
- allows young people to form friendships/relationships with people their own age.
- allows discovering talents and interests.

STEP 2 GOING AHEAD

2 A **A short text introduces Ss to Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs/Global Goals) and to the role of education for world leaders and countries around the world. Allow Ss time to read the text in silence. When they have finished, ask them to answer the two questions.**

ANSWERS:

1 The UN/193 countries around the world agreed on the Goals. The plan aims to eradicate poverty, ensure global growth and tackle climate change by 2030.
2 Global Goal 4 aims to ensure quality education for all by 2030.

B **Focus Ss on the title of the article (*Barriers to education*) and ask them to make a list of reasons that might prevent a child from regularly attending school. Elicit ideas but do not confirm any; this is intended to get Ss thinking.**

C **Allow time for Ss to read the article in silence. When they have finished, ask them to check their ideas from Ex 2B. Write on the IWB a list of possible reasons why children do not attend school regularly.**

SUGGESTED ANSWERS:

lack of funding
no teacher or untrained teachers
no classroom
overcrowded classroom
lack of learning/teaching materials; lack of basic facilities
gender
schools within areas affected by conflict
disability
poverty

D **Ask Ss to answer the question individually, then compare ideas with a partner.**

3 **Read Question 1 aloud and give Ss time to find the information in the article. Allow time for Ss to write their own answers to Questions 2 and 3. Encourage them to rephrase the information from the text and to use their own words as much as possible. Ss compare their answers in small groups. In feedback, elicit Ss' ideas as a class.**

ANSWERS:

1 Women and people with disabilities are groups of people who are still denied their right to education in some parts of the world. Other forms of discrimination include, for example, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations.
2 Schools may be destroyed by some natural disasters, which force students to leave their homes or to study outside.
3 Education and poverty are connected. Children from poor families are obliged to leave school and find a job, which leaves them without the necessary skills to further their careers. If education is a huge cost for a family, a child may be obliged to stay at home and find work instead of going to school.

Language for citizenship

4 **Explain that the Global Goals are not the first example of when leaders and nations around the world have agreed on the importance of the right to education for everyone. The UN Convention on the Rights of the Child has been ratified by 196 countries. Focus Ss on the titles of Articles 28 and 29.**

ANSWERS:

1 be free
2 be encouraged to go to school
3 respect children's rights
4 develop their personalities, talents and abilities
5 respect other people's rights, cultures and differences
6 protect the environment

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CRITICAL THINKING

The Italian Constitution

5 Give Ss time to read Article 34 of the Constitution and, either in L1 or in English, ask for comments. Ss should notice that the Constitution covers the same topics as the article they have read. The principle 'education for all' excludes all forms of discrimination. Hence the need for the State to remove all the obstacles which prevent schools from being accessible to everyone. You can ask Ss: *What kind of obstacles or barriers does the Italian Constitution seem to anticipate?* Explain that in 2005, Legislative Decree No 76 modified and extended the duration of compulsory education to 'at least twelve years or, in any case, until the attainment of a three-year qualification by the age of eighteen'.

ANSWERS:
1 c **2** e **3** d **4** b **5** a

STEP 3 TAKING ACTION

Digital literacies

6A As preparation for the final task, encourage Ss to read more about SDG 4 and its targets. They can use the internet, in class or at home, to do individual research.

B In class, allow Ss time to prepare a draft proposal with possible initiatives they could take to tackle some of the barriers to quality education in the place where they live. In feedback, elicit Ss' ideas as a class discussion.

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